

W. MELO DOUMANI

Football media creator, founder of The Reflective Football, and builder of strategy tools

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Fifteen years writing about football, then I built the thing I wanted to watch. I direct and cut the films, run the strategy work, and ship the software. All of it out of Dubai.

THE REFLECTIVE FOOTBALL, SINCE 1 MAY 2026

104,322

YouTube views

1,674 hrs

Watch time on YouTube

536,781

Instagram views in 90 days

720,558

YouTube impressions at 4.59% CTR

91%

Instagram reach from non-followers

AED 0

Spent on paid media

Top markets: United Kingdom, UAE, Spain, United States, Mexico

EXPERIENCE

2025 — PRESENT

Founder and Creator

The Reflective Football, Dubai

- Built a football media brand around Dubai's supporter culture, sole operator across concept, filming, editing and distribution.
- Season 1 followed the Arsenal, West Ham, Chelsea UAE, Aston Villa and Manchester United communities across five Dubai venues.
- Grew to 104,322 YouTube views and 536,781 Instagram views in the first three months with no paid media.
- Runs the funnel deliberately: Reels generate reach, YouTube holds the watch time, the site holds the audience.

2025 — 2026

Lead, Strategic Foresight and R&D

Standard Bank Group

- Retained as senior AI advisor to Africa's largest banking group for sovereign AI frameworks and expansion strategy.
- Presented decision-grade intelligence directly to the CEO of the Dubai branch and executive leadership.

2024 — 2025

Lead, AI Integration and Go-to-Market

e& (Etisalat), Abu Dhabi and Dubai

- Led AI adoption frameworks during e&'s shift from regional telco to global technology investment group.
- Built end-to-end go-to-market strategy for enterprise B2B AI services targeting ADNOC and major UAE corporates.
- Co-built proprietary AI copywriting datasets with Microsoft.

2022 — PRESENT

Founder and Venture Architect

Metron Ventures, Dubai

- Runs a five-platform AI innovation studio with a cross-functional team of engineers, designers and strategists.

- Designed METRON TPD Studio, a local-first strategy platform encoding 350 thinkers across 12 industries.
- Commercialised six sector intelligence reports across hospitality, F&B, media, marketing, education and Gulf tech.

Sports Journalist and Essayist

Arab News, The Watch Post, Meer

- Twenty years writing, fifteen of them on football, tennis and sports culture.
- Long-form match analysis and essays for regional and international titles, blending tactical insight with cultural commentary.
- The same editorial instinct now drives what gets filmed at The Reflective Football.

SELECTED FILMS

ARSENAL	22 Years of Heartbreak	Garden on 8
WEST HAM	The Final Day	Nelson's Bar
CHELSEA	The Supporters Club That Never Stops Believing	Belgian Beer Café
ASTON VILLA	Aston Villa Fans in Dubai	McGettigan's Factory
SPAIN	The Signs Were There	Garden on 8
MANCHESTER UNITED	Manchester United Fans in Dubai	Brooklyn Bar, Elite Byblos Hotel

BUILT

AI AGENT

METRON TPD Studio

An AI agent for business strategy. Convene a panel from 350 curated thinkers, work a real challenge through Arena, Intent, Audience, Challenge and Panel, then export the session as DOCX, PDF, PPTX or Markdown.

Next.js · Anthropic Claude API or local Ollama · Vercel · macOS Electron build

VOTING PLATFORM

The Reflectives

A live awards ballot across eight categories with timeline-synced nominee clips, gated sign-in, one-vote-per-user state and standings revealed after voting.

Next.js · Supabase · seeded nominee data

GAME

The Guesser

A football guessing game built into thereflectivefootball.com to turn passive viewers into returning members.

Next.js · Supabase

RESEARCH TOOL

The Beautiful Archive

A curated football knowledge index across nine mediums, 124 entries and counting. Google finds you pages, this tells you where to start.

Static JSON index · thinker-led recommendation flow

CONSUMER APP

MRMELO VIBES

A nostalgia music player with around 699 tracks and a DJ Set mode: build a set, dual-deck live crossfade, download the mix.

Static PWA · Web Audio API · Cloudflare R2 · Vercel

CONSUMER APP

Melo Culture Collection

A curated canon of 500 books, films, series and paintings with live UAE streaming availability and sourcing links for every entry.

Next.js · static JSON data

GAME

All In

A strategic card game. Empty your hand, then your visible cards, then the hidden ones. Commitment cards change the maths.

React · TypeScript · Vite · Zustand · Vitest · PWA

AI INSTRUMENT

Maestro, and Maestro 22

A sovereign, local-first thinking instrument: panels of thinkers, methodology packs and authorial voice styles, with plan-mode pre-flight, session forking, sub-agent Deepen runs and a semantically searchable archive. Maestro 22 is the chat-first rebuild, adding a live fact-sheet dossier beside the thread and hybrid vector plus lexical retrieval.

Next.js 15.5 · React · TypeScript · Tailwind · RAG · Ollama · nomic-embed-text · fully offline

AI INSTRUMENT

ScreenBuddy

A screenwriting partner that conceptualises with you, then writes line by line in turn. Scene list, logline drafting, and export to Fountain, FDX, PDF, DOCX and Markdown.

Next.js 15 · React · TypeScript · Ollama · runs entirely offline

STRATEGY AND RESEARCH

CONTENT STRATEGY

Built a two-platform funnel on purpose. Instagram Reels generate the reach, YouTube holds the watch time, the website holds the audience and the data. 91 percent of Instagram reach comes from non-followers.

COMMERCIAL STRATEGY

Benchmarked and priced a full sponsorship architecture at market mid-point across docuseries titles, venue retainers, podcast tiers, academies and event sponsorship.

APPLIED RESEARCH

Runs decision-grade research in 10 to 14 day sprints using the Dual Lens Framework. Commercialised six Distress Radar 2026 sector reports across hospitality, F&B, media, marketing, education and Gulf tech.

GO-TO-MARKET

Designed and shipped enterprise B2B AI go-to-market at e&, from brief to launch, targeting ADNOC and major UAE corporates.

TOOLKIT AND LANGUAGES

PRODUCTION

Adobe Premiere Pro, Adobe Creative Cloud, Audacity, Runway, ElevenLabs, OpusClip

BUILD

Next.js, React, TypeScript, Supabase, PostgreSQL, Prisma, Vercel, Electron

AI AND RESEARCH

Anthropic Claude API, Ollama, Perplexity, Obsidian, GitHub

LANGUAGES

English (native), Arabic (fluent), French (fluent), Spanish (conversational), Italian (conversational)

PUBLISHED

BOOKS

The Smudge on the Canvas

Amazon Kindle

The Cold War in Your Head

Amazon Kindle

Perspectives: Melo or Cypher

Amazon Kindle

PAPERS

Who Is Football For? Fan Testimony from the 2026 FIFA World Cup

<https://zenodo.org/records/21713449>

Beyond the Shot: A Relational Graph Framework for Contextually Accurate Expected Goals in Association Football

<https://zenodo.org/records/20082310>

The Translator Imperative: Cognitive Hybridity as the Mechanism of Human Evolution

<https://zenodo.org/records/18357660>

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